

Works Cited

Akenji, Lewis, et al. "Circular Economy and Plastics." *Circular Economy and Plastics: A Gap-Analysis in ASEAN Member States*, Institute for Global Environmental Strategies, 2019, pp. 14–20.

JSTOR, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/resrep21872.6>. Accessed 24 Mar. 2026.

This source is credible because it is a part of a book on the JSTOR website, which is a website well known for its credibility and the experts who write for it. So far, I have learned about the idea of a circular economy, which recycling plays a key role in.

Essentially, a circular economy involves reusing items instead of discarding them after a single use, allowing them to offset the creation of new materials. I plan to use this source to explain why recycling is important and why citizens should be actively taking the necessary steps to have their items properly recycled. I also plan to use this source to explain why recycling is good for conserving resources and reducing climate change. A possibility is creating a graphic from the information in this source to show how a circular economy works, the source includes a few graphics, so I could synthesize these.

Burcea, Ștefan Gabriel. "The Economical, Social and Environmental Implications of Informal Waste Collection and Recycling." *Theoretical and Empirical Researches in Urban Management*, vol. 10, no. 3, 2015, pp. 14–24. JSTOR, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/24873532>. Accessed 27 Mar. 2026.

"The economical, social and environmental implications of informal waste collection and recycling" is a peer reviewed source cited by other articles. The main topic of the article is the difference between informal and formal recycling, but it focuses on informal recycling. Formal recycling is done by enterprises, and is much more efficient compared to the recycling done by individuals and picked by people. I would like to inform people

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about how important it is for companies and larger groups to ensure the waste they create in any way is dealt with responsibly. For example, a factory might make things from plastic in molds, but each piece will have some waste, this will add up very quickly and is important to deal with. This is important because normal people must ensure that the products they buy are made responsibly, they can also talk to political representatives or support those who hold businesses accountable.

Carey, John. "On the Brink of a Recycling Revolution?: We're Awash in Plastics, Many of Which Are Hard to Recycle. Could Innovations, Girded by the Right Incentives, Finally Whittle Down the Piles of Plastic Waste?" *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America*, vol. 114, no. 4, 2017, pp. 612–16. *JSTOR*, <https://www.jstor.org/stable/26479025>. Accessed 27 Mar. 2026.

This source is a credible site because it is from a page called JSTOR and this is a great website for getting information about recycling. It is also edited by masters in their work to make sure that it is right. I learned that they take disgusting trash from the worst places and make them a good product. I also learned that the MBA director Mike Biddle says that they are going through a “quiet revolution” in the technology of product sorting. Saint Louis could take some of this new technology to increase the amount of contamination allowed in bins. The current problem is of people putting trash into recycling bins, if new technology could recycle this so called trash or filter it out, we could simplify our recycling process significantly. Our advocacy project could bring these ideas to life if we share knowledge with people, they could advocate to the city about this.

Works Cited

"City Dumpsters and Rollcarts - Saint Louis City Recycles." *Saint Louis City Recycles*, 9 Mar. 2026, stlcityrecycles.com/how-to-recycle-in-stl-city/how-to-recycle/city-dumpsters-rollcarts/. Accessed 29 Mar. 2026.

This source is the official recycling website for Saint Louis, therefore it is credible to give information about recycling in our city. I would like to use this source in our website to inform people about how they should recycle to ensure their efforts do not go to waste. Things I have learned include: the phone number to contact if recycling bin are overflowing, the fact that the bins should not be filled with plastic bags and many dates and times of pickups. For example, the pickups are either Monday and Friday or Tuesday and Thursday. More information that we can use includes "The City of St. Louis has shifted from alley recycling to drop-off recycling due to ineffectiveness and high costs." This quote shows the city's argument supporting the shift to the new drop of recycling system. This change is the highlight of our advocay project and website.

Cityofstlouissmissouri. "Public Infrastructure & Utilities Committee – August 14, 2025." *YouTube*, 14 Aug. 2025, www.youtube.com/watch?v=crYallizSxU. This is a credible source because it was published by the city of Saint Louis.

This source is a filming of a meeting where representatives give important in-sites into recycling in Saint Louis. So far, our have learned helpful statistics about the percent of recycling that gets recycled and how much we spend on recycling vs on trash this is important because the most important part of recycling is its cost. Our main plan is to use

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this source to explain why Saint Louis no longer has an alleyway recycling system, diving into specific stats when and if needed. Our secondary planned use for this source is to use it for an in-site into what the city plans to do for recycling in the future. We would also like to use clips of this video in our video we will create from our interview, It will add credibility to our claims if we show people in charge saying them.

Echeverría, Daniella, et al. "Waste Recycling and Reuse." *Circular Economy Proxy Measures: Indicators on Job Effects for a Closed-Loop Economy*, International Institute for Sustainable Development, 2020, pp. 7–8. *JSTOR*, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/resrep29240.6>. Accessed 24 Mar. 2026.

This source is very reliable because it comes from JSTOR, a data base well known for the reliability and credibility of the sources it hosts the writing is also cited in other works, The writing is peer reviewed, and the article So far, I have learned about the challenges of waste management and recycling. This source has also given us key information about the benefits of recycling in society, but also the downfalls and inefficiencies that come with recycling. I plan to primarily use this source to explain why recycling is so difficult to pull off, on a mass scale in a city like Saint Louis. My secondary use for this source to explain why it is important to acknowledge that recycling is difficult, if not impossible without citizen involvement, and I will highlight the importance of citizens doing their part. The source also acknowledges the importance of funding to help a recycling system succeed.

Works Cited

Ghosh, Sanchari. "Electronic Waste Recycling for Developing Economies." *Economic and Political Weekly*, vol. 46, no. 49, 2011, pp. 17–21. *JSTOR*, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/41319452>.

Accessed 27 Mar. 2026.

The article found on JSTOR is a really good source because it is on a credible site for research. This is because it is written by experts, and experts only post their articles after they have been looked over. This means that it is credible because it is not based on people's opinions, but it is based on research, which makes it credible compared to other sources found online, especially for school work. It is less related to saint louis itself, but because we all share the earth, supporting recycling in growing economies is very important because they create a significant portion of the worlds waste, and have less secured landfills and disposal areas. I would like to advocate for those who can to support these projects financially, as it can increase jobs in growing economies and protect our planet at the same time. I would like to make an article on our website relate to this.

Goodship, Vannessa. "Plastic Recycling." *Science Progress (1933-)*, vol. 90, no. 4, 2007, pp. 245–68. *JSTOR*, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/43423211>. Accessed 29 Mar. 2026.

This article is on JSTOR, which is a well known and very well respected source, which is how I know it is a reputable and academically credible source. So far I have learned about different types of plastics and their make ups. I've learned about how plastics are made up of polymers and additives, some additives, like glass fibre, range from 5% to 80% of the plastic's make up. I plan to use this source for helping identify plastics make up and how that contributes to why they can or cannot be recycled. A helpful graphic for our website could include a pie chart comparison showing different plastics and their

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impact on the environment. This is important because plastics have different abilities to be recycled, and their use after recycling is impacted by their ability to melt. If people are informed about different plastics, they can be sure to buy those that work well.

Jain, Akshat, editor. "What Can Be Recycled and How Many Times?" *Plastic Recycling: Decoded*, Centre for Science and Environment, 2021, pp. 18–22. *JSTOR*, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/resrep37920.8>. Accessed 24 Mar. 2026.

This source is credible because it comes from JSTOR, which is a well known and trusted data base of educational and reliable sources. So far, I have learned about the RIC code system which helps categorize plastics, I have known about this system for a while, but this source clearly lays out information about each code and clarifies what I did not yet know. This source has also taught me about down cycling which involves recycling plastics into lesser products. I plan to primarily use this source to help clear confusion about what can and should be recycled and what cannot be recycled. Secondly I would like to use this source to talk about down-cycling, what it means and why its important to keep in mind. Down cycling is where materials have reduced quality each time they are recycled or reused. I need to emphasize the importance or reusing, because it is way more efficient.

Krull, Ryan. "St. Louis Officials Say Recycling Revamp Is Already Paying Off." *St. Louis Magazine*, 29 Oct. 2025, www.stlmag.com/news/stlouis-recycling-drop-sites-results/. It can be generally stated that an article in the St. Louis Magazine can be regarded as credible.

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This is because it is an old article. The writers of this article are professionals. Furthermore, they have been subjected to editing, and it is safe to say that what they have written in this article is true. The article is also likely to be true in terms of matters relating to the region, like recycling, because it is a magazine relating to this region. The article could also have included true-life stories and quotes from people in this field, like Cara Spencer's quote the mayor of St. Louis. The article has quotes we can use, showing Cara Spencer's support for the current system. Many of the stats in the article are misleading, while this doesn't prove anything, it could show that the new system isn't going exactly as planned. We can use these quotes in our interview with the mayor

Spencer, Cara. Personal Interview. 5 April 2026

We chose to interview the current mayor, (Cara Spencer) she recently has reformed the recycling situation in our city, and is arguably the most important public figure in the case of the city's recycling system. Overall, this interview gave us more insight, Spencer told us that the most effective way for people to improve how recycling works in our city is to learn about what can and can't be recycled, we are going to do this with things like our recycling game, or quiz. This will make it interactive and interesting for people to learn. A good quote from Spencer is "young people can improve what goes into landfills is by consuming less, buy stuff secondhand and look for ways in which you can prevent things from being made to begin with.", this is also something we will do for our project.

Works Cited

United States Congress. *Save Our Seas 2.0 Act*. S. 1982, 116th Congress, 2019–2020. *Congress.gov*, www.congress.gov/bills/116/congress/senate-bill/1982/text.

This source is credible because it is a signed law passed by congress and signed by the president in 2020. The law is very detailed, but outline actions to be taken by our government. it includes a new “Genius Prize for Save Our Seas Innovations”, to encourage innovation. It also creates a nonprofit to organize donations. I would like to analyze this law, to determined where it fell short in order to promote change on those things. I could write an article on my website showing the impact this act had as well as how it did not work. Showing people how the act didn't work could encourage them to support more congressional acts related to recycling. according to other sources, the government supporting recycling is the best was to incentives private organizations to improve their recycling. Overall, the save our seas act benefited the world, but had some shortcomings.

United States Environmental Protection Agency. "National Recycling Strategy." *EPA.gov*, 13 Nov. 2019, www.epa.gov/circulareconomy/national-recycling-strategy.

This source is credible because it is published by the US government, as part of the environmental protection agency, It was published very recently on January 23, 2026 and outlines the timeline and achievements set by the EPA to improve recycling in general. The “National recycling goal” is to increase recycling by 50%. The EPA is requesting public comment on its draft of the National recycling goals. In my opinion, many of the goals set by this government plan are quite unambitious and I would like to use this article to show that. I could also use this article to show the organizations that are and aren't in the pledge. Because public comment is being requested, this is an easy way for

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people to make an impact, i would like to find an email to allow people to comment on this through my website, i could even create a thing to allow them to submit comments which i could then email myself.

United States Environmental Protection Agency. "What Is a Circular Economy?" *EPA.gov*, 4 Sept. 2025, www.epa.gov/circulareconomy/what-circular-economy.

This source is credible because it is published by the US government, as part of the environmental protection agency. It was published in November of 2024, and has been updated multiple times, most recently in September of 2025. The article was written due to the save our seas act, an law passed in 2020 (amended most recently in 2025) that I would like to find other sources on specifically and talk about in our final project. The general idea of a circular economy is that resources should be used repeatedly until they have broken down or are impossible to reuse with the overall goal of increasing the lifetime of all materials. The outcome of a circular economy is to decrease the material disposed of, and the new products created. This article includes statistics and goals the government has set for reducing our impact on the environment. I think it would be helpful to show/ display to our audience some of the graphics on this article, because they are very thorough yet easy to understand.

van Ewijk, Stijn, and Julia Stegemann. "Waste Recycling." *An Introduction to Waste Management and Circular Economy*, UCL Press, 2023, pp. 216–55. *JSTOR*, <https://doi.org/10.2307/jj.4350575.15>. Accessed 23 Mar. 2026.

Works Cited

This source is credible because it is peer reviewed, I found it on jstore but it is a chapter from a book on waste management and circular economies. The source goes over more detailed ways things are recycled, but an important detail is the difference between open and closed loop recycling. Open loop recycling is when items lose quality (and usability) each time they are reused, and closed loop recycling maintains the exact materials. The article explains that recycling is never perfect, as mistakes and contamination always lead to loss of material. I would like to use this article to determine the difference between recycling different materials, I could advocate to explain the ways different object can be recycled to encourage people to buy things that can be recycled easier. Additionally, i would like to emphasize the importance for people to try to reuse something instead of recycling it.

"Waste and Recycling Studies and Reports." *Missouri Department of Natural Resources*, 2020, dnr.mo.gov/waste-recycling/what-were-doing/studies-reports.

This page is the current studies being funded by the government of Missouri (department of waste) related to waste management and recycling It is credible because it is part of the government and I have confirmed its information with other sites. I would like to use this page to inform people about what is being done specifically in our state about recycling. One of the studies that is complete is a study on the ability to use recycled tires in concrete, the result was that the rubber could be a partial replacement and improved sound insulation of the concrete. The benefit to using old tires in concrete is that we would be able to use less limestone in our concrete and replace it with tires which are

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already manufactured. I would like to include a link to this page to allow citizens to read what our government is working on

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